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EUROPEAN UNION AVIATION SAFETY AGENCY
DIRECTORATE OF AERODROMES & AIR TRAFFIC MANAGEMENT

REGULATORY TECHNICAL SYNTHESIS
EASA/ADR.OPS/SYNTH-2024-01

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EASA Part-ADR.OPS Regulatory Synthesis: Obstacle Safeguarding & Aerodrome Works Safety

Regulation (EU) No 139/2014 Annex IV • Hard Law (Implementing Rules) vs. Soft Law (AMC & GM)

STATUTORY JURISDICTION & REFERENCE PUBLICATIONS:
- **Regulation (EU) No 139/2014** (Aerodromes Regulation): Annex IV (Part-ADR.OPS: Points ADR.OPS.B.070, B.075 & B.080).
- **ED Decision 2014/012/R** (CS and AMC/GM for Aerodromes Design and Operations), amended by ED Decision 2024/004/R.
- **Target Audience:** Aerodrome Inspectors, Civil Aviation Technical Officers (TSEEAC), Airside Operations Managers & ATS.

Executive Summary: The core provisions from Annex IV (Part-ADR.OPS) of the EASA Easy Access Rules for Aerodromes (Regulation (EU) No 139/2014) covering Obstacle Control, Safeguarding, and Aerodrome Works Safety are synthesized below. This operational document presents mandatory *Implementing Rules (Hard Law)* alongside corresponding *Acceptable Means of Compliance (AMC)* and *Guidance Material (GM) (Soft Law)* to guide aerodrome technical officers during safety surveillance, site inspections, and regulatory compliance reviews.

SECTION 1: OBSTACLE CONTROL & SAFEGUARDING

Point ADR.OPS.B.075 — Safeguarding of Aerodromes IMPLEMENTING RULE • HARD LAW

(Commission Regulation (EU) No 139/2014, Annex IV)

Implementing Rule (Hard Law Requirements):

1. **Continuous Surveillance:** The aerodrome operator is legally required to monitor the aerodrome movement area and its immediate surroundings:
   - Obstacle limitation and protection surfaces (OLS / OPS) established in accordance with the aerodrome's certified design basis.
   - The physical marking and lighting of certified obstacles to initiate appropriate corrective and enforcement action within its remit.
   - Hazards arising from human activities and land use (e.g., urban developments, building cranes, reflective solar glare, sources of turbulence, smoke emissions, or wildlife attractants).
2. **Risk Mitigation Procedures:** The operator must establish, publish, and maintain robust procedures to mitigate operational risks stemming from obstacles, tall construction equipment, or land use changes within the monitored areas that could compromise the safety of aircraft operations during approach, takeoff, or visual circling.

OPERATIONAL DIRECTIVE: MANDATORY VS. ADVISORY LANGUAGE
In EASA statutory texts, the verb **"shall"** or **"must"** denotes an unconditional legal obligation (Hard Law). Failure to comply constitutes a formal Level 1 or Level 2 audit non-compliance. In contrast, **"should"** introduces Acceptable Means of Compliance (AMC), requiring an approved Equivalent Level of Safety (ELOS) if deviated from.

SECTION 1 (CONTINUED): SAFEGUARDING SURVEILLANCE & VEHICLE LIGHTING

AMC1 ADR.OPS.B.075 — Monitoring & Operational Coordination AMC • SOFT LAW

Acceptable Means of Compliance Specifications:

1. **Scope & Protocol Definition:** The aerodrome operator, in formal coordination with the National Competent Authority (e.g., DSAC) and the Air Traffic Services (ATS) provider, must clearly define the geographic boundaries, surveillance frequencies, and specific operational tasks governing the aerodrome safeguarding process.
2. **Visual & Instrumental Surveillance:** Daily surveillance routines must ensure that all sectors visible during regular movement area safety inspections are checked for unauthorized structures, temporary cranes, or mobile contractor machinery penetrating Obstacle Limitation Surfaces (OLS).
3. **Visual Line-of-Sight Protection:** Safeguarding arrangements must explicitly preserve and protect direct, unobstructed visual lines of sight required from:
   - The Air Traffic Control Tower Visual Control Room (VCR) to all runway thresholds, taxiways, and movement surfaces.
   - Dedicated Apron Management Service (AMS) observation posts and marshaling checkpoints.
   - The Rescue and Firefighting Service (RFFS) watch room to primary response departure routes and runway approaches.

GM1 ADR.OPS.B.075 — Risk Assessment & Local Authority Interface GUIDANCE MATERIAL

Guidance Material on Off-Aerodrome Coordination:

Where obstacles, construction cranes, or industrial activities fall outside the aerodrome boundary (beyond the direct legal jurisdiction of the aerodrome operator), the operator must establish formal liaison with municipal urban planning bodies, regional authorities, and the civil aviation directorate. This liaison ensures that building permits, temporary crane operations, and zoning development plans are reviewed and verified prior to construction commencement.

POINT ADR.OPS.B.080 — MARKING & LIGHTING OF VEHICLES AND MOBILE OBJECTS

Point ADR.OPS.B.080 — Movement Area Mobile Equipment IMPLEMENTING RULE • HARD LAW

(Commission Regulation (EU) No 139/2014, Annex IV)

Implementing Rule Requirements:

- **Conspicuous Marking:** All vehicles and mobile equipment—excluding operating aircraft—deployed on the movement area must be conspicuously marked with high-visibility paint schemes, reflective chevrons, or approved conspicuity tape.
- **Obstacle Service Lighting:** When operated at night or in low-visibility operations (LVP), vehicles must display activated service lights, including 360-degree flashing yellow/amber obstacle beacons visible from any airside viewing angle.
- **Exemption Criteria:** Dedicated apron-only servicing equipment (such as non-motorized baggage dollies or passenger stairs) may be exempted from specific lighting rules only under conditions strictly documented and justified in the approved Aerodrome Manual.

SECTION 2: RUNWAY SAFETY & AERODROME WORKS

Point ADR.OPS.B.070 — Aerodrome Works Safety IMPLEMENTING RULE • HARD LAW

(Amended by Commission Regulation (EU) 2020/2148 and ED Decision 2024/004/R)

Implementing Rule (Hard Law Requirements):

1. **Mandatory Safety Procedures:** The aerodrome operator must establish, document, and enforce procedures ensuring that:
   - Aircraft operational safety is never compromised by aerodrome construction, maintenance, or resurfacing works.
   - Construction crews, equipment operators, and maintenance sites are safeguarded against hazards created by live aircraft operations (e.g., jet engine blast, prop wash, and engine foreign object ingestion).
2. **Prohibition of Unplanned Interventions:** Unannounced, spontaneous, or unplanned maintenance activities on or near active runways and taxiways are strictly prohibited. All works must follow formal safety coordination, risk assessment, and defined hand-back criteria.

AMC1 ADR.OPS.B.070 — Worksite Management & Runway Safety Zones AMC • SOFT LAW

Acceptable Means of Compliance Provisions:

- **Safety Assessment Mandate:** Any planned works taking place on the manoeuvring area require a comprehensive safety risk assessment evaluating runway incursion hazards, pavement contamination from debris/FOD, and temporary taxiway routing restrictions.
- **Temporary Obstacle Buffers:** Contractor machinery, excavated earth mounds, and temporary construction scaffolding must remain strictly outside the cleared runway strip (150 m from centerline on code 4 runways) and approach/take-off climb surfaces while the runway is active.
- **Reduced Runway Length Operations:** When works necessitate displaced thresholds or shortened declared distances (TORA, TODA, ASDA, LDA):
  - Physical safety buffer zones (including temporary RESA) must be demarcated on the pavement.
  - Aeronautical ground lighting, approach visual aids, and painted runway markings must be adapted or masked.
  - Official aeronautical safety notifications must be published via NOTAM and AIP Supplement without delay.

> **SAFETY INVARIANT: DECLARED DISTANCES UNDER WORKS**
> When a runway threshold is temporarily displaced forward, **LDA (Landing Distance Available)** and **TORA (Take-Off Run Available)** must be recalculated and verified by technical officers before issuing NOTAMs. Flight crews must never be required to calculate temporary margins in flight.

SECTION 2 (CONTINUED): WORKSITE DEMARCATION & RETURN TO SERVICE

GM1 ADR.OPS.B.070(d) — Worksite Demarcation & Pavement Hand-Back GUIDANCE MATERIAL

Worksite Demarcation & Physical Protection: Worksites located on or adjacent to active paved movement areas must be continuously demarcated with high-visibility frangible barriers, retroreflective hazard cones, and amber unserviceability warning lights. Barriers must withstand localized aircraft jet blast while remaining frangible upon vehicle impact.

Mandatory Return to Service (Hand-Back) Protocols: Before an affected runway or taxiway segment is certified for return to service and handed back to live air traffic, a joint physical inspection must be conducted by airside safety officers and air traffic control. The inspection must verify that:

- The active pavement is certified **broom-clean** (completely swept, vacuumed, and free of foreign object debris/FOD).
- All temporary construction vehicles, barriers, and temporary lighting installations have been evacuated beyond safety clearances.
- Visual aids, aeronautical ground lighting (AGL), and pavement markings fully match the published NOTAM conditions.

SURVEILLANCE & INSPECTION CROSS-REFERENCE MATRIX

Operational Topic	Implementing Rule	Soft Law Reference	Inspector Surveillance Focus
Runway Strips & Clearances	Part-ADR.OPS.B.015 Part-ADR.OPS.B.070	AMC1 ADR.OPS.B.015	Surface grading, drainage stability, frangibility of fixtures, and zero temporary obstructions inside strip margins.
FOD Control Programme	Part-ADR.OPS.B.016	AMC1 ADR.OPS.B.016	Runway sweeping logs, automated FOD detection protocols, and post-maintenance clean-up hand-back records.
Surface Movement Guidance & Control	Part-ADR.OPS.B.025 Part-ADR.OPS.B.030	AMC1 ADR.OPS.B.030	Airside driver permits (ADA), runway-holding position stopbars, mandatory ATS read-backs, and low-visibility rules.
Obstacle Surface Safeguarding	Part-ADR.OPS.B.075	AMC1 ADR.OPS.B.075 GM1 ADR.OPS.B.075	OLS daily surveillance routines, crane notification permits, and urban planning liaison with municipal authorities.

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